

THE POWER OF C.E.S.H.

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #182

No, CESH is not an 80's TV series about a talking computer car. It's a great early jazz education idea from Jerry Coker, standing for Contrapuntal Elaboration of Static Harmony. It's a mouthful, but really is a great concept that has things in common with Voice Leading, Guide Tones and many classic melodies in jazz (and long before). In A Sentimental Mood, Mission Impossible, My Funny Valentine, Question & Answer, and so many more.

In short a CESH is where there is some chromatic motion (contrapuntal motion) in a chord that isn't itself moving (the "static harmony" part). We see the CESH device in melodies, solo lines, chord voicings and big band horn arrangements. We find examples over many types of harmony, including major, minor and dominant chords, and more.

#1 - "In Walked Bud" (Thelonious Monk)



#2 - "Tenor Madness" (Sonny Rollins)



#3 - George Coleman solo on "Bittersweet"



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